The `terms` query expects a list of search words to be queried against a field, passed in as an array to the `terms` object. The array values are searched against the existing documents one by one to fetch matches. Each word is matched exactly. In this listing, we search for all movies with a PG-13 or R rating in the `certificate` field. The resultant documents combine all PG-13 and R movies.

There's a limit to how many terms we can set in the array: a whopping 65,536 terms. If we need to modify this limit (to increase or decrease it), we can use the index's dynamic `index.max_terms_count` property setting to alter the limit. The following query sets `max_terms_count` to 10.

Listing 9.5 Resetting the maximum number of terms

```
PUT movies/_settings
{
  "index":{
    "max_terms_count":10
  }
}
```

This setting restricts a user setting no more than 10 values in the `terms` array. Remember, this is a dynamic setting on the index, so we can change it on a live index.

There's a slightly different version of the `terms` query: a `terms` lookup query. The idea is to create the `terms` array from an existing document's values rather than setting it specifically. The next section discusses it with an example.

9.3.1 Example terms query

So far, we have provided a list of values in an array as the search criteria for a `terms` query. A `terms` lookup query is a variation of a `terms` query that lets us set the terms by reading an existing document's field values. It is best understood with an example.

To explain this feature, we need to deviate from our movies data set, create a new index with appropriate schema, and index a few documents. The following listing creates a `classic_movies` index with two properties: `title` and `director`.

Listing 9.6 Creating a new index

```
PUT classic_movies
{
  "mappings": {
    "properties": {
      "title": {
        "type": "text"
      },
      "director": {
        "type": "keyword"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

The title field is a text field.

Declares the director field as keyword type